THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE COAL THESIS

The Marginal Tonne

In the first half of 2026, coal-fired generation supplied 49.7 per cent of China's electricity — below half for the first time on record. In the same six months, the country's largest listed coal producers reported rising realised prices, and China Coal Energy earned more money selling eight per cent less coal. China Shenhua's board meets in Beijing today to sign off its own interim numbers, having guided in July to a profit increase of between 6.9 and 21.1 per cent.

Those two facts are usually treated as contradictory. They are not. They are what happens when a commodity's share of a growing system falls slowly while its supply is cut quickly. The question is no longer whether coal is in structural decline — the generation data says it is losing share — but whether that decline is fast enough to matter to the price of the last tonne sold.

A reframe worth holding onto

The internal Wiki, drawing on 13D Research, argues that falling Chinese coal output is a bullish signal rather than a bearish one: mine accidents and the safety inspections that follow them cluster in bull markets, when producers are pushed past capacity limits. On this reading, the 15th Five-Year Plan's concentration of output into five large bases is "Supply Side Reform 2.0" — a policy that hands pricing power to a shrinking number of state-owned integrated producers. This is 13D's view, not a forecast, and it is the single largest interpretive leap in the theme.

Method. External figures — generation shares, output, imports, company results, seaborne prices — are drawn from the National Energy Administration, the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air, company interim announcements and the IEA, each dated at the point of use. Internal figures and interpretations come from the Heyokha Wiki's Coal theme page and the 13D Research issues behind it; these are labelled as internal views. Where the two disagree, the disagreement is stated rather than reconciled. No figure that could not be sourced has been carried forward.

Consider a city of two million where the number of taxi journeys taken each year has finally begun to drift down — ride-hailing, better buses, more people working from home. The trend is real and the direction is settled. Then, in May, a fatal crash kills dozens of passengers. The licensing authority suspends inspections province-wide and pulls roughly one tenth of the cabs off the road within weeks. Journeys fall. Fares rise. The remaining drivers have their best quarter in two years. An observer who fixed on the falling ride count — the structural story, and the correct one — would have drawn precisely the wrong conclusion about the price of a fare. The ride count tells you about the industry's future. The number of licensed cabs tells you about this quarter's takings. Chinese coal is currently being priced by the second of those, and analysed by the first.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

RMB 8.14bn

China Coal Energy's first-half net profit attributable to shareholders, up 5.8 per cent, achieved on commercial coal production of 61.95 million tonnes — down 8 per cent after post-accident safety inspections. Interim dividend of RMB 0.184 a share declared.

China Coal Energy interim results, 21 August 2026.

US$131.25

Newcastle seaborne thermal coal, per tonne, on 26 August 2026 — roughly a fifth below the level the benchmark had held since late February. The seaborne market is not repricing alongside the Chinese domestic one.

NEWC benchmark, as at 26 August 2026.

+49%

Growth in Chinese thermal power capacity additions in the first half of 2026, to 38.4 GW. New coal plants entering operation reached the highest first-half level since 2016 — in the same period coal's generation share fell below half.

CREA, published 19 August 2026.

WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED

A milestone and a shortage, in the same six months

On 30 July the National Energy Administration disclosed that coal-fired plants generated 2.5 trillion kilowatt-hours in the first half of 2026, or 49.7 per cent of China's total electricity output. It is the first time coal has supplied less than half. Combined wind and solar capacity reached 1.95 billion kilowatts by the end of June, up 16.8 per cent on the year, and renewable generation of nearly 2 trillion kWh accounted for 41.2 per cent of the total. Read on its own, the release describes a transition proceeding roughly to plan.

The production data describes something else. Chinese coal output fell 10.1 per cent year on year in July and is down 2.9 per cent across the first seven months, according to the Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air; output has now gone a full twelve months without a single month of year-on-year growth. The proximate cause is not policy but a fatal accident. A mine disaster in May — the deadliest in China in seventeen years — triggered industry-wide safety inspections, which producers have cited directly as the reason their volumes fell. Imports have absorbed the gap: up 20 per cent in July and 4.3 per cent across the first seven months.

The result is that the two halves of the coal complex are telling opposite stories at the same moment. Coal is losing share of a slowly growing electricity system, and the domestic tonne is scarcer than it has been in two years. Neither observation cancels the other. What matters commercially is that the tonne is priced by the second condition and forecast by the first, and the two operate on different clocks — supply discipline resets in months, generation share in decades.

There is a second-order driver worth naming, because it is temporary and often mistaken for structure. Disruption to shipping through the Strait of Hormuz has cut Chinese crude imports by 24.3 per cent year on year and gas-fired generation by 13.9 per cent. That has pushed petrochemical feedstock demand toward coal-to-chemicals, which the internal Wiki identifies as the fastest-growing source of Chinese coal demand. The IEA attributes its own upgrade to 2026 global coal-fired generation — up 1.4 per cent, after a roughly flat 2025 — substantially to the same LNG disruption and to energy prices around 30 per cent above early-2025 levels. A geopolitical accident is doing part of the work being attributed to a supercycle.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A falling share is not a falling volume. A falling volume is not a falling price. A commodity is priced by the last tonne that clears the market, not by the average one — and the last tonne can get dearer for years inside a market that is, in aggregate, slowly shrinking. *Confusing the trend with the margin is the most expensive error available in a declining commodity.*

MECHANISM

How a safety inspection becomes an earnings beat

1. A fatal accident

A mine disaster in May 2026 — China's deadliest in seventeen years — halts operations at the site and forces a national response. Producers name it in their own results calls as the trigger for what follows.

→

2. Province-wide inspection

Safety checks sweep the key producing provinces, principally Shanxi. Mines are suspended rather than throttled, so the supply loss is lumpy and immediate rather than gradual.

→

3. Inventories destock

National output falls 10.1 per cent year on year in July. Port and utility stockpiles draw down through the summer peak. The marginal buyer must bid to secure a tonne.

→

4. Realised prices follow

Domestic benchmarks clear higher; contracted and spot realisations catch up with a lag. China Coal Energy sold self-produced coal at RMB 524 a tonne in the first half, more than a year earlier. Imports fill the residual gap.

Sequence constructed from CREA output and import data (19 August 2026), China Coal Energy's interim results and results call (21 and 24 August 2026), and the internal Wiki's account of post-accident Shanxi inspections (13D, 13 August 2026). The Wiki names the May incident as the Liushenyu accident; China Coal Energy's results call refers to "the Xinji incident". Whether these are the same event under different names has not been resolved here.

49.7%

Coal's share of Chinese electricity generation in the first half of 2026 — below half for the first time on record. Coal-fired output of 2.5 trillion kWh.

−10.1%

Year-on-year fall in Chinese coal output in July 2026. Output has now gone a full year without year-on-year growth; imports rose 20 per cent in the same month.

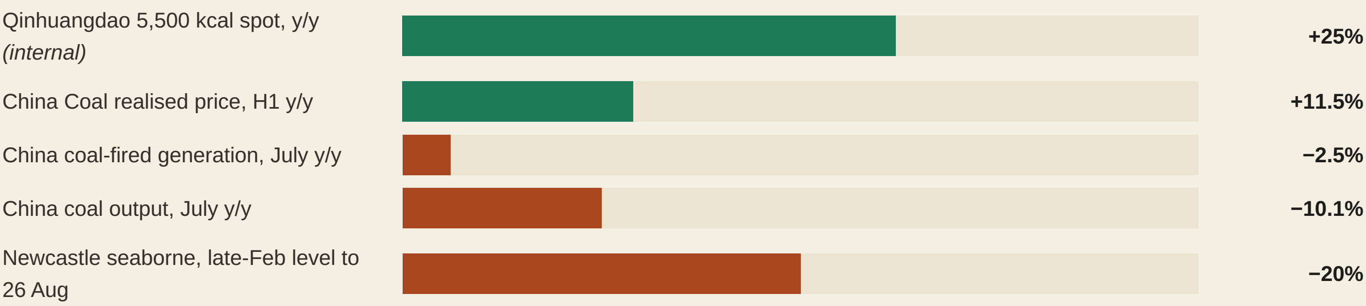
+11.5%

Reported year-on-year rise in China Coal Energy's realised price for self-produced commercial coal in the first half, to RMB 524 a tonne, on 8 per cent lower volume.

Left: National Energy Administration press conference, 30 July 2026. Centre: CREA China Energy and Emissions Trends, July 2026 snapshot, published 19 August 2026. Right: China Coal Energy interim results and results call, 21 and 24 August 2026 — see the note on internal inconsistency in that disclosure under Sources.

THE CENTRAL COMPARISON

Two coal markets, moving apart



Bars are illustrative and scaled to absolute percentage change, not to a common base; they are not a price index. Qinhuangdao figure is an internal 13D quotation (13 August 2026) and has not been independently verified here. China Coal realised price from interim results, 21 August 2026. Generation and output from CREA, 19 August 2026. Newcastle from the NEWC benchmark at US$131.25/t on 26 August 2026 against a level sustained above US$165/t from late February 2026.

The divergence in the bottom two bars is the part of this story that is least discussed and most consequential. A Chinese domestic squeeze driven by domestic safety enforcement does not automatically transmit to the seaborne market — indeed it can pull in the other direction, since Chinese buyers import more when domestic tonnes are short, which supports seaborne volumes but has evidently not supported seaborne prices. An investor who owns the theme through Australian or Indonesian export exposure owns a different, and currently weaker, market from one who owns Shenhua or Shaanxi Coal.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Chinese coal is now two businesses inside one balance sheet: a regulated volume business that is slowly shrinking, and an unregulated scarcity business that is not. The listed producers own both. Which one dominates reported earnings in any given half depends less on the energy transition than on how many mines the safety inspectorate has closed. *That is a policy variable, not a commodity cycle.*

THE RECORD

What has actually shifted

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
Coal fell below half of Chinese generation	49.7 per cent of output in H1 2026, on 2.5 trillion kWh; renewables at 41.2 per cent, wind and solar capacity up 16.8 per cent year on year (NEA, 30 July 2026).	A genuine structural milestone, and a headline that invites investors to exit. But share fell partly because total demand grew; absolute coal-fired volume did not fall by anything like the same amount.
Domestic supply is being cut faster than demand	Output −10.1 per cent in July and −2.9 per cent year to date, with no month of growth in a year; imports +20 per cent in July (CREA, 19 August 2026).	Supports realised prices now. But an enforcement-driven cut can be reversed by the same inspectorate that imposed it, and mines have already been resuming in Shanxi.
Coal-fired generation fell for the first time this year	−2.5 per cent year on year in July, after six consecutive months of growth; coal and gas together still +2 per cent year to date (CREA, 19 August 2026).	Undercuts the claim that the output fall is purely a supply story — demand fell too. But one month after six of growth, in a year of unusually poor wind, is not a trend.
Coal capacity is still being built	38.4 GW of thermal additions in H1, +49 per cent year on year; new coal plants entering operation at the highest first-half level since 2016 (CREA, 19 August 2026).	Locks in decades of fuel demand and confirms coal's role as system backup. It also depresses utilisation and raises curtailment across the fleet, so more capacity does not mean more tonnes burned.
Industrial coal demand is visibly weak	Crude steel −3.6 per cent and cement −11.6 per cent year on year in July, cement at its lowest for the period since 2020 (CREA, 19 August 2026).	A direct drag on metallurgical and industrial coal, tied to property. It also means the price strength is coming from power and chemicals alone — a narrower base than a true supercycle would have.
A geopolitical shock is flattering the numbers	Chinese crude imports −24.3 per cent and gas generation −13.9 per cent on Hormuz disruption; IEA attributes its 2026 upgrade to +1.4 per cent global	Real demand, and it may persist for as long as the disruption does. But it is a substitution effect with an identifiable cause and therefore an identifiable

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
	coal generation largely to LNG disruption and ~30 per cent higher energy prices.	end, which is not the same thing as structural growth.

BOTH SIDES

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The bull case

- **Supply is being administered downward.** Output has not grown year on year in twelve months and fell 10.1 per cent in July. The 15th Five-Year Plan directs 80 per cent of national production into five bases by 2030, against 75.6 per cent in 2020, and suspends new small mines in key regions — a concentration of pricing power (internal; 13D, 13 August 2026).
- **The earnings are already arriving.** China Coal Energy grew first-half net profit 5.8 per cent to RMB 8.14 billion on 8 per cent lower volume and declared an interim dividend. Shenhua guided to first-half profit growth of 6.9 to 21.1 per cent. These are reported and guided figures, not projections.
- **Coal-to-chemicals is a new demand leg.** With oil-based feedstock disrupted, coal-to-chemicals has been running at high utilisation and is identified internally as the fastest-growing source of Chinese coal demand — a use that is indifferent to the power-generation share.
- **Capacity keeps being built.** 38.4 GW of thermal additions in the first half, up 49 per cent, at the fastest first-half pace since 2016. Plants built now will need fuel into the 2050s regardless of what share they run at.
- **The yields are being paid.** Shenhua's H shares yielded 5.08 per cent at HK$44.44 on 20 August; Shaanxi Coal is quoted around 6.2 per cent. In a sector that is not reinvesting into growth, cash is returned rather than sunk.
- **The transition is not linear.** Poor wind conditions and rising curtailment meant coal and gas generation still rose 2 per cent year to date despite record renewable capacity — a reminder that installed capacity and delivered electricity are different quantities.

The bear case

- **The headline profit growth is thinner than it looks.** Yankuang guided first-half net profit to around RMB 7.2 billion, up roughly 53 per cent — but earnings excluding non-recurring items to about RMB 4.5 billion, up 2 per cent. The difference is investment income from an equity transfer, against FX hedging losses, impairments and tax provisions. Core coal earnings barely moved.
- **The seaborne market disagrees.** Newcastle at US$131.25 on 26 August is roughly a fifth below the level held since late February. If this were a global scarcity event rather than a Chinese enforcement event, the export benchmark would not be falling.
- **Demand fell too.** Coal-fired generation declined 2.5 per cent year on year in July, the first fall of 2026, after coal power fell in 2025 for the first time in a decade. Attributing the whole output decline to supply discipline requires ignoring this.
- **The squeeze is reversible by decree.** Output was cut by inspection, not by depletion. Mines in the key provinces have already been resuming. The same administrative lever that created the shortage can end it, on no notice and for no market reason.
- **The demand uplift has a named, temporary cause.** The IEA attributes 2026's global coal-generation increase largely to Hormuz LNG disruption and elevated energy prices, and still expects global demand to plateau and drift lower toward 2030. Substitution that begins with a blockade tends to end with one.
- **The industrial leg is broken.** Cement output is down 11.6 per cent and at its weakest for the period since 2020; crude steel is down 3.6 per cent. The property-linked demand that underwrote the last coal cycle is not coming back on this data.

WHERE THE VIEWS COLLIDE

The disagreement this edition cannot settle

The internal Wiki and the external record look at the same July and draw opposite conclusions from it. 13D reads the output decline as confirmation of a bull market, on the historical observation that fatal accidents cluster in periods of rising prices when producers are pushed past capacity — and concludes that Chinese coal consumption "cannot be confirmed to have peaked." CREA looks at the identical month and records that coal-fired generation fell 2.5 per cent, the first decline of 2026, following a fall in Chinese coal power in 2025 for the first time in a decade. Both are describing real data. Neither has established how much of the 10.1 per cent output fall is suspended supply and how much is absent demand, and until the inspection regime relaxes and the wind resource normalises, nobody can. That is not a gap this edition can close, and it should be held open rather than resolved by preference.

A second, narrower conflict: the internal page's most recent forward-looking claim is that the Qinhuangdao benchmark is heading toward 1,000 yuan a tonne. The externally visible market is a seaborne benchmark that has fallen by around a fifth since February. These are different contracts and can legitimately diverge — but an investor holding the theme should know which of the two their instrument is exposed to, because the internal thesis is specific to the Chinese domestic tonne and the internal Wiki does not say so explicitly.

LIMITATION ON THE INTERNAL VIEW

Every one of the thirty-seven sources listed on the Heyokha Wiki's Coal page is a 13D Research WILTW issue. There is no Greed & Fear, no Solid Ground, no White Box, no CLSA and no independent counterweight anywhere in the theme's evidence base. The page's own Contradictions section reads, in full, "None yet" — which in a theme this contested is a statement about source diversity rather than about the world. The page was created on 23 June 2026 and last reviewed on 24 June 2026, so its framing predates the July generation milestone, the July output collapse and the entire first-half reporting season by two months. The bear case as written on the page is short, undated and still cites IEA projections running only "through 2024". Accordingly, the bear case in this edition has been rebuilt almost entirely from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own results, not taken from the Wiki.

SIGNALS

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Shenhua's interim results	Board met in Beijing today, 28 August, to approve first-half results and consider an interim dividend, against July guidance of +6.9 to +21.1 per cent on a first-half 2025 base of RMB 24.6 billion.	The largest and most liquid expression of the theme. Where the number lands inside that wide guided range, and what the payout is, sets the sector's tone into the autumn.
Monthly coal output	Whether the year-on-year decline narrows from July's 10.1 per cent as suspended mines resume.	The single cleanest test of whether the squeeze is administrative and temporary or persistent. A fast recovery in output would remove the price support without changing anything structural.
Coal-fired generation, month by month	Whether July's 2.5 per cent decline was an artefact of one month or the start of a run.	Separates the supply story from the demand story. Two or three more negative months would make the bear case much harder to argue against.
The Newcastle–Qinhuangdao spread	Seaborne at US$131.25 and falling; the domestic benchmark reported firm and rising.	Tells you whether this is a global commodity event or a Chinese regulatory one, and therefore which listed exposures actually express the thesis.
Hormuz shipping and LNG flows	Chinese crude imports were down 24.3 per cent and gas generation down 13.9 per cent in July on the disruption.	A material share of both the coal-to-chemicals demand surge and the IEA's 2026 upgrade rests on this. Normalisation removes it.
Wind and solar utilisation, not capacity	Wind generation fell 4.5 per cent in July on poor conditions even as first-half wind additions of 38.6 GW exceeded any full year before 2025.	Coal's 2026 resilience has depended heavily on weather and curtailment. A normal wind year with less curtailment would displace coal volume without any new policy.

EXPRESSION

Three postures, not one answer

Own the cash, not the cycle

Hold the large Chinese state-owned integrated producers for the distribution rather than the commodity view — Shenhua's H shares yielded 5.08 per cent in late August, Shaanxi Coal around 6.2 per cent. **The cost:** you are underwriting a terminal-decline asset with a policy-set payout, and accepting that the dividend can be cut in exactly the half when the coal price is weakest.

Own the scarcity, briefly

Treat this as an enforcement-driven squeeze with a knowable end, and hold the most operationally geared domestic producers only while output remains suppressed. **The cost:** the exit signal is an administrative decision you cannot see coming, and the position is crowded with people who believe it is structural and will not sell into the resumption.

Own the substitution

Express it through coal-to-chemicals rather than thermal coal, on the view that oil-to-coal feedstock switching survives a Hormuz normalisation because the plants are built and the cost curve holds. **The cost:** a bet on a spread, not a commodity, and if oil falls back the entire economic rationale for the switch narrows sharply.

The companies named below are illustrative of how the theme is expressed in listed markets. They are NOT recommendations. No view is offered on the suitability of any security for any investor, and nothing here constitutes investment advice.

1088 HK

HK$44.44
20 Aug 2026

China Shenhua Energy

The integrated benchmark: mines, dedicated rail, ports and power plants under one roof, which is why its earnings fall by less than the industry's when prices drop. In the first half of 2025 it earned RMB 24.6 billion while sector-wide coal mining profits fell 53 per cent. July guidance points to first-half 2026 profit growth of 6.9 to 21.1 per cent. The H shares yielded 5.08 per cent in late August.

WATCH NEXT

> Today's board meeting: where inside the guided range the number lands, and the size of the interim dividend.

1898 HK

RMB 8.14bn H1
21 Aug 2026

China Coal Energy

The clearest reported evidence for the marginal-tonne argument. First-half revenue of RMB 73.13 billion was broadly flat, but net profit attributable rose 5.8 per cent to RMB 8.14 billion on commercial coal production of 61.95 million tonnes, down 8 per cent after post-accident safety inspections. Self-produced coal realised RMB 524 a tonne. An interim dividend of RMB 0.184 was declared.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether second-half volumes recover as inspections ease, and whether realised prices hold when they do.

601225 CH

Yield ~6.2%
Aug 2026

Shaanxi Coal Industry

A low-cost domestic thermal producer concentrated in one of the five bases the 15th Five-Year Plan is designed to favour, and therefore among the most direct beneficiaries if the consolidation proceeds as drafted. It is also the purest domestic-price exposure on this list, with no seaborne offset and no chemicals leg — which cuts both ways given the Newcastle divergence.

WATCH NEXT

> Interim results and any commentary on how base consolidation affects its own volume allocations.

1171 HK

RMB 7.2bn flagged
14 Jul 2026

Yankuang Energy

The cautionary case. Its positive profit alert flagged first-half net profit of roughly RMB 7.2 billion, up about 53 per cent — but earnings excluding non-recurring items of around RMB 4.5 billion, up 2 per cent. The gap is investment income from an equity transfer, offset by FX hedging losses, impairments and tax-related provisions. Market capitalisation was HK$168.5 billion in late August; consensus rating Hold, target HK$15.00.

WATCH NEXT

> The full interim statement, and whether core coal margin improves once the one-off items are stripped out.

600989 CH

Internal only
7 May 2026

Baofeng Energy

The coal-to-chemicals expression, and the one place the Hormuz substitution shows up most directly. The internal Wiki records first-quarter operating cash flow up 62.8 per cent year on year and the Ningdong olefins project running above nameplate. These are internally sourced figures from a 13D issue and have not been independently verified here; they are reproduced as an internal view, not as established fact.

WATCH NEXT

> Interim results, and olefin-to-naphtha spreads if crude routes through Hormuz normalise.

3668 HK

US$131.25 NEWC
26 Aug 2026

Yancoal Australia

The seaborne counterweight, and majority-owned by Yankuang. Its interim revenue rose with broadly stable profit — a very different profile from the Chinese domestic producers, and consistent with a Newcastle benchmark roughly a fifth below its late-February level. Holding the theme here is holding a different market from holding it in Shanghai or Hong Kong.

WATCH NEXT

> Whether the Newcastle–Qinhuangdao gap narrows, which would suggest the squeeze is genuinely global.

The bottom line

What was repriced this summer was not the future of coal. It was the availability of Chinese coal in the second half of 2026. An accident in May produced an inspection regime that removed roughly a tenth of monthly output, port inventories drew down through the peak season, and the producers who still had tonnes to sell realised better prices on smaller volumes. That is a supply event with a policy cause and a policy end date, and it arrived in the same six months in which coal's share of Chinese generation fell below half for the first time. Both things are true. Only one of them is in the current earnings.

The evidence is genuinely mixed and should not be tidied. Reported first-half profits rose at China Coal Energy, but Yankuang's core earnings rose 2 per cent once one-offs are stripped out; the domestic benchmark firmed while Newcastle fell about a fifth; output dropped 10.1 per cent but generation dropped too. The reasonable inference is that the domestic Chinese tonne is in a real, administratively created shortage that is supporting real earnings, and that this is not the same thing as the global coal supercycle the internal page describes. The next test is close at hand: Shenhua's number today, and then the September and October output prints, which will show whether the suspended mines came back — and with them, the price.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal. Heyokha Wiki, **Coal** (theme, active, 4,924 words; created 23 June 2026; last reviewed 24 June 2026; aliases coal-mining, thermal-coal, metallurgical-coal; tickers 601225 CH, 601088 CH, 1088 HK). Sections used: Thesis; What would change it; The energy transition eventually wins; Contradictions; "May 2026: Coal-to-chemicals boom, record oil-to-coal discount, and flattening production"; "June–August 2026: the Liushenyu accident, Supply Side Reform 2.0, and record prices". Provider issues relied on: **13D WILTW, 13 August 2026** ("coal's Supply-Side-Reform 2.0"; Liushenyu accident and Shanxi inspections; June output of 381Mt, −9.7 per cent; July imports 42.7Mt, +20 per cent; Qinhuangdao 5,500 kcal at 854 yuan/t, +25 per cent year on year; NDRC 15th Five-Year Plan five-base target of 80 per cent by 2030 against 75.6 per cent in 2020; Indonesian July seaborne exports 38.2Mt, −6.9 per cent); **13D WILTW, 11 June 2026** (coal supercycle breakout); **13D WILTW, 7 May 2026** (Brent-to-Qinhuangdao ratio above 8.0x; coal-to-chemicals demand; Baofeng Energy first-quarter operating cash flow +62.8 per cent; Yankuang added to the 13D China Cyclical Opportunities index). Related entity pages consulted: Shenhua Energy, Shaanxi Coal, Yankuang Energy. The Wiki also records an unresolved internal contradiction on 2025 coal-to-chemicals consumption — 430Mt (+10.2 per cent) per the 7 May issue against 362Mt (+11.5 per cent) per the 13 August issue — and that figure has therefore not been used in this edition.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. All thirty-seven sources listed on the Coal page are 13D Research WILTW issues. The theme has no second provider, and its Contradictions section is empty by the page's own admission. Its bear case is three short undated paragraphs citing IEA projections that run only "through 2024", and the page was last reviewed on 24 June 2026 — before the National Energy Administration's below-50-per-cent disclosure, before July's output and generation data, and before the first-half reporting season. Readers should treat the internal material as one house's argument, assembled before the evidence that most tests it.

(c) External sources. [1] National Energy Administration press conference, via Xinhua, *30 July 2026*: coal-fired power 49.7 per cent of H1 2026 electricity output, first time below 50 per cent; coal-fired generation 2.5 trillion kWh; wind and solar capacity 1.95 billion kW at end-June, +16.8 per cent; renewable generation nearly 2 trillion kWh, +about 9 per cent, 41.2 per cent of total. **[2] CREA**, *China Energy and Emissions Trends — July 2026 snapshot*, published *19 August 2026*: coal output −10.1 per cent in July, −2.9 per cent January–July, a full year without growth; imports +20 per cent July, +4.3 per cent January–July; coal power generation −2.5 per cent after six months of growth, coal and gas together +2 per cent year to date; gas power −13.9 per cent; solar generation +10.4 per cent; wind generation −4.5 per cent; crude imports −24.3 per cent; H1 additions 72.1 GW solar (−66 per cent), 38.6 GW wind (−25 per cent), 38.4 GW thermal (+49 per cent), new coal plants entering operation at the highest first-half level since 2016; crude steel −3.6 per cent, cement −11.6 per cent. **[3] China Coal Energy** interim results, released *21 August 2026*, briefing *24 August 2026*: revenue RMB 73.13 billion; net profit attributable (CAS) RMB 8.14 billion, +5.8 per cent; under IFRS, profit before tax +7.1 per cent and attributable profit +11.8 per cent; commercial coal production 61.95 million tonnes, −8 per cent; sales 119.7 million tonnes; self-produced ASP RMB 524 per tonne, reported +11.5 per cent; interim dividend RMB 0.184 per share; volume decline attributed to industry-wide safety inspections after the May incident. *Note:* the disclosure as transcribed is internally inconsistent twice — a production fall given as both 3.39 million tonnes and 8 per cent, and a price rise as both RMB 34 per tonne and 11.5 per cent. Neither pair can both hold. The levels and directions are not in doubt; the percentages are reproduced as reported, with this caveat. **[4] Yankuang Energy** positive profit alert, *14 July 2026*: H1 net profit about RMB 7.2 billion, +roughly 53 per cent; excluding non-recurring items about RMB 4.5 billion, +2 per cent; drivers higher coal and coal chemical prices plus investment income from the Inner Mongolia Xintai Coal equity transfer, offset by FX hedging losses, impairments and tax-related provisions. Market capitalisation HK$168.5 billion; most recent rating Hold, target HK$15.00, as at *26 August 2026*. **[5] China Shenhua Energy**: guidance of *20 July 2026* for H1 net profit +6.9 to +21.1 per cent; board meeting convened in Beijing for *28 August 2026* to approve results to 30 June 2026 and consider an interim dividend; H shares HK$44.44, yield 5.08 per cent, as at *20 August 2026*; H1 2025 comparative net profit RMB 24.6 billion, against sector-wide coal mining and washing profits down 53.0 per cent over January–June 2025. **[6] Newcastle (NEWC)** seaborne thermal coal: US$131.25 per tonne on *26 August 2026*, −0.30 per cent on the day, near US$130 in mid-August, against a level sustained above US$165 from late February 2026. **[7] IEA**: global coal-fired generation forecast +1.4 per cent in 2026 after a roughly flat 2025, attributed substantially to Hormuz LNG disruption and energy prices around 30 per cent above early-2025 levels; global coal demand a record 8.85 billion tonnes in 2025 (+0.5 per cent), marginally lower in 2026, on a plateau that may decline slightly by 2030. **[8] Shaanxi Coal Industry** dividend yield quoted between approximately 6.18 and 6.32 per cent across providers as at *August 2026*; rounded in text to "around 6.2 per cent" to reflect that dispersion.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. *Topic selection.* Source-summary pages from the twenty-one days to 28 August 2026 were scored by entity recency (three points within three days, two within seven, one within twenty-one) with a three-point bonus for entities named in a source title, then filtered to active theme pages. The highest scorers — gold, gold miners, AI capex and copper — were all inside the thirty-day cooldown. Coal was the highest-scoring eligible theme, carrying the title bonus from the 13D WILTW of 13 August 2026, and has never previously been an edition. *Cooldown verification.* The HB Wiki Learning archive was read directly and in full; all twenty-nine prior editions were parsed by filename and the cooldown set established with complete confidence. No inference was required. *Tool status.* The Heyokha Wiki server and the archive folder were both available; no fallback to browser research was needed. Two oversized tool responses were queried selectively from disk rather than read whole. *Figures dropped.* An early search returned H1 figures of RMB 118.039 billion revenue and RMB 14.529 billion attributable profit for China Coal Energy; these belonged to a different reporting period and were discarded in favour of the results-call figures. A report of Shenhua guiding to RMB 28.6–30.6 billion proved on inspection to date from July 2024 and was likewise discarded. *Structure.* Because the internal page's bear case is thin, undated and predates the material evidence, the bear column and most of the "what has actually shifted" table were built from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own disclosures rather than from the Wiki.
